

Dr. Tobias Grieb

HEAD OF ENGINEERING · AI STRATEGY & DEVELOPER VELOCITY

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LinkedIn · Xing



EXECUTIVE PROFILE

PhD computer scientist (Dr. rer. nat., summa cum laude) and experienced engineering leader with over 15 years of progressive leadership responsibility in technology-driven companies at various stages of maturity. My strength lies in taking engineering organisations to the next level: through rigorous value stream optimisation from idea to production, targeted use of AI-driven development tools to measurably increase developer velocity, and a leadership culture in which psychological safety and direct feedback enable genuine ownership and continuous improvement. I design team structures that minimise dependencies and reduce cognitive load, and communicate confidently at C-level as well as with product management and business units.

CORE COMPETENCIES

ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP & CULTURE

Disciplinary leadership up to 50+ people · Engineering Manager Coaching · Psychological Safety & Feedback Culture · Ownership & Continuous Improvement · Career Framework & Performance Management · Recruiting & Retention

TECHNOLOGY & ARCHITECTURE

Java / Spring Boot · Kubernetes / Docker · AWS · Red Hat OpenShift · React · CI/CD · DevOps · Multi-tenant System Architecture · API-first · Microservices · Technical Roadmap

AI & DEVELOPER VELOCITY

AI-Assisted Coding · LLM Workflow Integration · Automated Documentation · Developer Experience (DevEx) · DORA Metrics & Performance Indicators · Value Stream Optimisation · Cognitive Load & Team Autonomy

IT MANAGEMENT & GOVERNANCE

Budget & Investment Planning (€1–5M) · Portfolio & Project Prioritisation · Make-or-Buy Decisions · Provider & Contract Management · Compliance Infrastructure (GDPR) · Audit-Readiness

ORGANISATION DESIGN & VALUE STREAMS

Agile Governance & Value Streams · Organisational Design · Minimising Dependencies · Clear Ownership along Service Architecture · OKR Framework · Interface Management

STAKEHOLDERS & COMMUNICATION

C-Level & Management Reporting · Product Management Interface · Customer Care Alignment · Cross-functional Team Management · Corporate Governance · External Partner Management

LEADERSHIP COMPETENCIES AT EXECUTIVE LEVEL

- ▶ AI Integration & Developer Velocity: AI-Assisted Coding, LLM Workflows, DORA Metrics
- ▶ Organisational Development: Career Frameworks, Succession Planning, Feedback Culture
- ▶ Enterprise Architecture Management: Target Architecture, Fit/Gap, Modernisation Programmes
- ▶ IT Compliance & Risk Management: GDPR, Audit-Readiness, Zero-Trust Principles
- ▶ Value Stream Design: minimise cognitive load, team autonomy, service ownership
- ▶ Digital Product & Platform Strategy (Cloud-native, multi-tenancy, API Economy)
- ▶ IT Financial Management: CapEx/OpEx, Cloud Cost Optimisation (FinOps)
- ▶ Change Management: cultural & structural IT transformation at organisational level

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of Consulting · Cloudfactory GmbH

Dec 2025 – present

*IT Consulting · Strategic Enterprise Partnerships***RESPONSIBILITIES & RESULTS**

As Head of Consulting, Dr. Griebel leads the strategic consulting of enterprise partners on digital platform development, AI-driven engineering processes and modern engineering organisations. A central engagement is the advisory mandate with **50Hertz Transmission GmbH / Elia Group**, one of Europe's leading transmission system operators, on building a scalable digital developer platform. Responsibilities include platform strategy design, delivery management and executive-level client communication.

TECHNOLOGY, METHODS & GOVERNANCE

Consulting engagements focus on cloud-native developer platforms, integrating AI-assisted development workflows (AI-Assisted Coding, LLM-based automation) into the software lifecycle, and developer experience strategies to measurably increase productivity. Supporting teams in building scalable delivery structures and value stream-oriented organisational models for complex enterprise environments.

Engineering Director · sevDesk GmbH, Offenburg

Feb 2023 – Nov 2025

*Cloud Accounting SaaS · ~400 employees · Series B***RESPONSIBILITIES & RESULTS**

As Engineering Director, Dr. Griebel led two of the three pillars of sevDesk's R&D organisation: Platform Engineering and Growth & Retention. He steered roadmap, technical vision and architecture strategy across both areas and owned headcount and hiring budget in close coordination with management. A central result of his tenure is the initiation and management of a company-wide application modernisation programme migrating the grown product landscape to a cloud-native, containerised target architecture (Kubernetes/Docker on AWS). DORA metrics (Deployment Frequency, Lead Time, Change Failure Rate, MTTR) were established as the basis for delivery performance measurement; derived bottleneck analyses drive continuous value stream optimisation. The technical roadmap is aligned with management in the OKR framework and operationalised in measurable quarterly goals.

LEADERSHIP & ORGANISATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Dr. Griebel led 6 Engineering Managers directly, with indirect responsibility for over 40 software engineers. The central leadership principle is the establishment of a culture of psychological safety and direct feedback, in which ownership and continuous improvement are genuinely lived. He established a company-wide career framework and performance management system creating structured development paths, transparent evaluation criteria and a performance-oriented feedback culture. A key organisational focus was the strategic development of the Platform Engineering pillar as an independent unit, including full ownership of the hiring process for a dedicated Engineering Director position. Recruiting and retaining top talent are integral to his strategic leadership agenda.

AI INTEGRATION & DEVELOPER VELOCITY

Under Dr. Griebel's leadership, the integration of AI-assisted development tools into the software lifecycle was systematically advanced: AI-Assisted Coding (GitHub Copilot) and automated code review support were introduced to measurably increase individual developer flow and eliminate administrative friction. Productivity improvements were quantified via DORA metrics and developer experience surveys.

TECHNOLOGY, METHODS & GOVERNANCE

The product stack includes Spring Boot/Kotlin, PHP and React; platform infrastructure is based on Docker and Kubernetes on AWS. Under Dr. Griebel's leadership, a strategic shift-and-lift programme migrated the entire development infrastructure from GitLab to GitHub, including full transformation of CI/CD pipelines and the automation landscape under a consistent DevSecOps approach: security scanning, dependency auditing and compliance checks are now integral to every delivery pipeline. Architectural standards, API-first principles and Architecture Decision Records (ADRs) as a governance instrument were also established.

Head of Software Development & Platform Architecture · Würth Cloud Services GmbH, Bad

Apr 2021 – Jan 2023

*Mergentheim**Corporate Startup within Würth Group · B2B SaaS for Tradespeople · DAX Corporate Context with Startup Agility***RESPONSIBILITIES & RESULTS**

At Würth Cloud Services, Dr. Griebel led both the modernisation of existing legacy systems and the parallel build-out of new platform components. A central result was the transformation of individually grown system components into a scalable, multi-tenant platform architecture serving a heterogeneous user base of small and medium-sized tradespeople consistently across mobile and desktop applications. Target architecture definition, modernisation portfolio prioritisation by business value, and operational management all lay within his sole responsibility, including headcount and investment budget management in close coordination with Würth IT and the group board.

LEADERSHIP & ORGANISATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Dr. Griebel built the engineering team from the ground up, managing frontend, backend and mobile engineers across the full employee lifecycle. In the corporate startup context, he established a leadership culture combining technical excellence with ownership; clear responsibilities along the service architecture minimised dependencies and reduced cognitive load across teams. People development was oriented around individual strengths and the strategic capability build of the organisation.

TECHNOLOGY, METHODS & GOVERNANCE

Platform architecture was based on Red Hat OpenShift in the Würth data centre, complemented by Docker and Kubernetes for container orchestration; the product stack included PHP, TypeScript/JavaScript, Node.js, Java, Spring Boot, React and Flutter. Architecture decisions were taken and documented in line with Würth Group IT governance and security standards, consistently linking enterprise architecture principles with agile delivery practice.

Head of Competence Centre Digitalisation Consulting · adesso SE, Dortmund

Jun 2016 – Aug 2019

*Leading German IT Consultancy · Enterprise Clients across Industry and Public Sector · Promoted from Team Lead to CC Head***RESPONSIBILITIES & RESULTS**

As Head of the Competence Centre for Digitalisation Consulting, Dr. Griebel was responsible for the strategic development and independent management of a profitable consulting practice at one of Germany's leading IT service providers. He acquired and delivered IT transformation projects for enterprise clients with project volumes of €1–5M, from initial needs analysis and fit/gap assessment through make-or-buy decisions to delivery of complex cloud-native architectures. A central focus was value stream-oriented delivery: optimising the end-to-end process from idea to production was a core quality criterion of the IT transformations delivered.

LEADERSHIP & ORGANISATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Dr. Griebel built an interdisciplinary team of consultants and engineers of up to 10–20 people, taking full disciplinary and professional leadership responsibility. He developed structured competency paths, conducted regular performance and potential reviews, and established systematic knowledge transfer within the team. He entered the leadership role as Team Lead (Jun 2016) and assumed overall responsibility for the Competence Centre within eighteen months (Nov 2017). Coaching and mentoring in day-to-day project work and fostering team cohesion were central leadership principles.

TECHNOLOGY, METHODS & GOVERNANCE

Projects covered cloud-native architectures with microservices, Java Spring Boot, Docker and Kubernetes; mobile application design and the introduction of agile governance models (Scrum, Kanban) at enterprise clients. Requirements engineering (user stories, fit/gap analyses), solution design and architecture reviews were integral to project roles. Project management and documentation used Jira, Confluence and MS-TFS; build and source code management with Git and Jenkins/TeamCity.

Lead Product Manager, IT Application Landscape & Platform · Durstexpress GmbH, Berlin

Sep 2019 – Mar 2021

*Hyper-Growth FMCG E-Commerce Startup · Logistics & Warehouse Platform · Microsoft Azure***RESPONSIBILITIES & RESULTS**

Product management of a large IT application landscape in retail, logistics and warehousing in a hyper-growth environment. Design of a scalable system landscape with mobile and desktop components on Microsoft Azure (Docker, Kubernetes); design and implementation of a mobile B2B/B2E software solution for over 3,500 warehouse and logistics employees. C-level stakeholder management, agile requirements engineering and value stream management as the interface between business and engineering.

LEADERSHIP & ORGANISATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Disciplinary and professional management of cross-functional software teams across the full employee lifecycle: recruiting, qualification, career development and retention in a high-growth environment. Building structures and disciplines in product management as a standalone function; developing people and evaluating performance and potential.

EARLIER POSITIONS

Jan 2014 – Apr 2016	Head of Research Group Mobile Applications & Processes	paluno / University of Duisburg-Essen
Jul 2010 – Jan 2014	Research Associate, Software Engineering	paluno / University of Duisburg-Essen
Jul 2009 – Jun 2010	Research Associate, Applied Telematics / e-Business	University of Leipzig

EDUCATION

PhD Dr. rer. nat. SUMMA CUM LAUDE	2017
"Method and Technology for Model-Based Automation of Tests for Context-Sensitive Mobile Applications"	
University of Duisburg-Essen · Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Klaus Pohl, paluno – The Ruhr Institute for Software Technology	
Diplom (MSc) Computer Science	2009
University of Leipzig · Thesis: "Generating Test Plans from UML Activity Diagrams using Model Transformation" · Minor: Philosophy	

LANGUAGES

German	Native
English	Business fluent

PERSONAL DETAILS

Date of birth	16 Oct 1981, Strausberg
Nationality	German
Location	15345 Eggersdorf (near Berlin)

METHODS & FOCUS AREAS

AI & Developer Velocity	AI-Assisted Coding, LLM Workflows, DORA
Scrum / Kanban	Long-standing practitioner & coach
OKR Framework	Company-wide rollout (sevDesk)
DevSecOps / CI/CD	GitLab-to-GitHub migration, GitHub Actions

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS & RESEARCH

During academic career (2009–2016), several peer-reviewed publications in the areas of **mobile software engineering**, model-based testing and context-sensitive application architectures. Research was supported by industry-funded projects conducted in close collaboration with corporate partners.

Topics: Model-Based Testing · UML · Mobile Architectures · Quality Assurance · Context-Aware Systems

CERTIFICATIONS

Scrum Alliance	Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO)
Agile Leadership	Certified Agile Leadership (CAL) · Scrum Alliance
ISTQB	Certified Tester Foundation Level (CTFL)